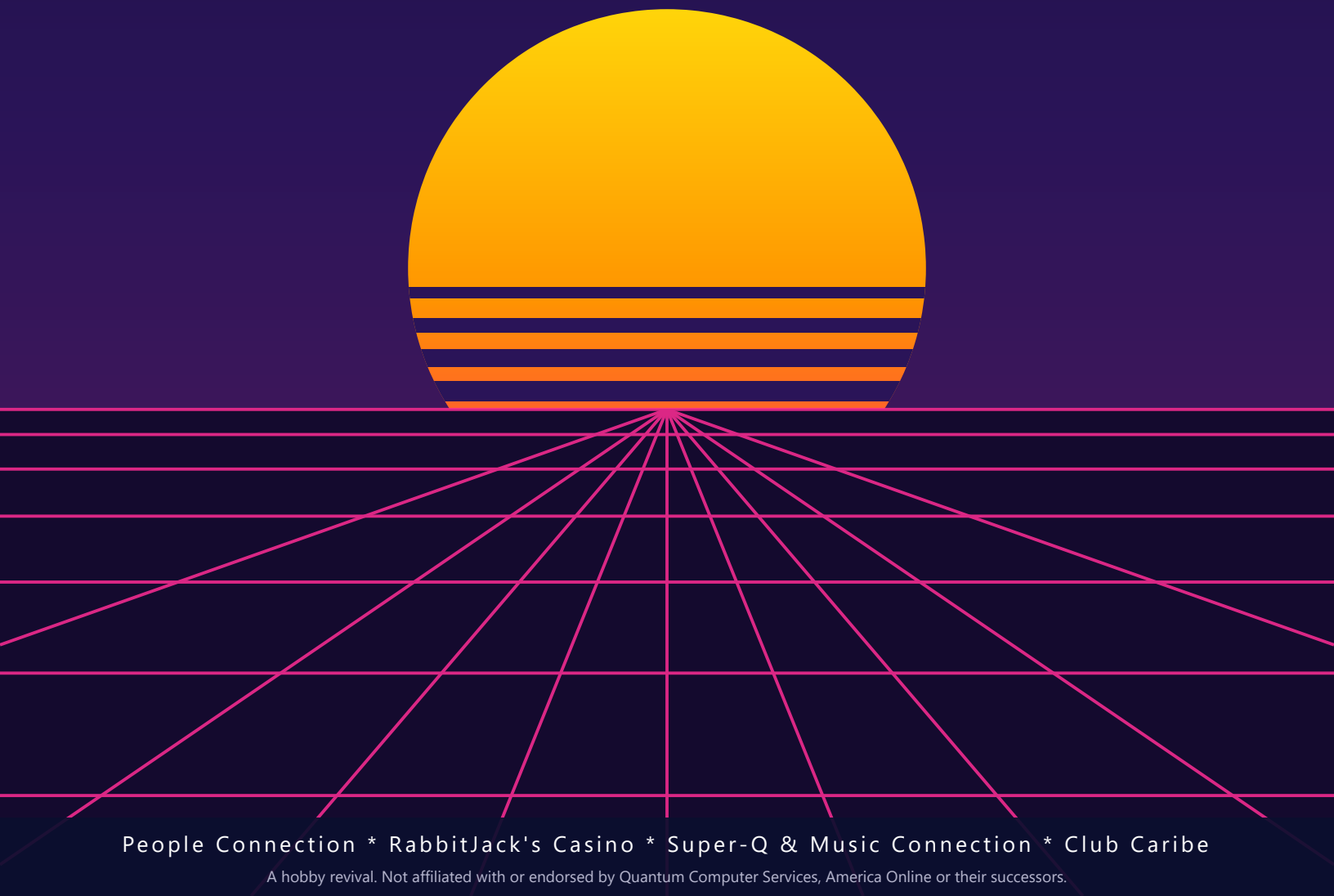
Q-LINK RELOADED

MEMBER'S GUIDE

THE ON-LINE SERVICE FOR YOUR COMMODORE 64



People Connection * RabbitJack's Casino * Super-Q & Music Connection * Club Caribe

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Member's Guide

Edition 1 · for the Q-Link Reloaded service at **qlink.kd4cbm.us** · Commodore 64 and 128 (in 64 mode)

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Welcome Aboard!

Welcome to **Q-Link Reloaded**, the on-line service for your Commodore 64.

From 1985 to 1994, Quantum Computer Services ran Q-Link, the place where Commodore owners met, chatted, played games against each other across the country and swapped news, all through a modem and a single disk. When the service closed, its software lived on in the disk boxes of its members. Q-Link Reloaded brings the other end of the phone line back: a new server that speaks the language of your original Q-Link disks.

With this guide and your Q-Link disk you can:

- **Meet people** in People Connection, the heart of Q-Link: public and private rooms, private messages and more.
- **Play head to head**: Four in a Row, Chess and the other Q-Link games, live against another member.
- **Try your luck** in **RabbitJack's Casino**: blackjack, slot machines, bingo and stud poker, with play money called Q-Chips.
- **Tune in** with **Super-Q** and the **Music Connection**: thousands of Commodore tunes, played on your SID chip, alone or for the whole room.
- **Visit Club Caribe**, Lucasfilm's animated world of avatars, the ancestor of every on-line world since.
- **Keep up** with live news headlines and Q-Link mail.

Everything in this guide has been tried on real Commodore 64s and in the VICE emulator. Where something does not work yet, we say so.

Welcome to the network. See you on-line!
The Q-Link Reloaded Team

Q-Link Reloaded is a non-commercial hobby revival. It is not affiliated with or endorsed by Quantum Computer Services, America Online or their successors. Q-Link, People Connection, RabbitJack's Casino, Club Caribe and Habitat are names of their original owners, used here only to describe compatibility. Q-Chips are play money with no cash value.

1. Getting Started

What you need

Item	Notes
Commodore 64 (or 128 in 64 mode)	or the **VICE** emulator on a PC or Mac (see "Using an emulator" below)
Disk drive	a 1541 or compatible, an SD2IEC, or an **Ultimate** cartridge or Commodore 64 Ultimate
Modem	a Hayes-compatible modem on the **user port**, set to **1200 baud**: a Wi-Fi modem or the Ultimate's modem. It must be able to dial an Internet address
Your Q-Link disk	the Q-Link (version 4) program disk. Use a **copy**, never your only original
Optional disks	the two Q-Link game disks; the RabbitJack's Casino disk; the Super-Q disk; the two Club Caribe disks
A joystick	for Club Caribe (port 1)

Make your working disk

Q-Link writes your account number and access code onto your program disk when you join. So:

1. Make a copy of your Q-Link disk and keep the original safe.
2. Leave the copy **write-enabled** (no write-protect tab). Q-Link must be able to write to it.
3. Use **one disk per member**. Your disk is your key to your account: do not lend it, and do not make copies for friends.

Set up your modem

Q-Link talks to the service over a plain 1200-baud connection. Before you start Q-Link, set your modem to 1200 baud as its manual describes.

> **IMPORTANT** Dial **raw**, with `ATD`, not `ATDT`. Many Wi-Fi modems treat `ATDT` as "Telnet mode" and quietly remove one special character from the data. Q-Link then works until, say, your casino balance happens to be 255 or 511, and freezes. With `ATD` everything gets through.

Starting Q-Link

1. Switch on your modem, drive and computer, and put your Q-Link disk in the drive.

2. Type the command below and press **RETURN**. The program loads and starts on its own.

```
LOAD"*",8,1
```

1. Choose your modem setup in Q-Link and **manual dialing**. When Q-Link is ready for you to dial, type your modem's dial command with the service's address and port:

```
ATDQLINK.KD4CBM.US:5190
```

(Most Wi-Fi modems take the address and port this way; check your modem's manual if yours differs.) When the modem answers `CONNECT`, Q-Link takes over and signs you on.

Using an emulator

VICE works very well. Use its user-port RS-232 modem emulation pointed straight at the service:

VICE setting	Value
User port device	RS-232 (user port), device 1, **1200 baud**
RS-232 device 1	`qlink.kd4cbm.us:5190`
IP232	**off** (it removes the same special character Telnet does)
Drive 8	your Q-Link disk image (a **copy**; it gets written to)

Keep each member's disk images in a folder on your own computer, not on a network drive: if a network drive locks the image, Q-Link cannot save to it and stops just after signing on.

2. Signing On

Your first visit

On a brand-new disk, Q-Link signs you up:

1. **Choose a screen name**: up to 10 letters and digits. It is how everyone will know you, and it cannot be one that is already taken.
2. **Tell us where you are**: Q-Link asks for your name, city, state and country. Other members see **only your city, state and country** when they Identify you; your name is not shown.
3. Q-Link writes your account number and **access code** onto your disk. That is why the disk must be write-enabled.

From then on, starting Q-Link and connecting signs you straight in.

> **TIP** Lost your disk, or Q-Link says your access code is wrong? The system operator can give your account a new access code. Enter it with the `CHANGE ACCESS` program on your Q-Link disk, and you are back in.

The Main Menu

After signing on you arrive at the Q-Link main menu. Move the highlight with the cursor keys and choose with **F1**; **F5** takes you back. The departments that are open on Q-Link Reloaded today:

Department	What you will find
People Connection	chat rooms, private messages, games, the casino, Super-Q, Club Caribe
News & Information	Live News Headlines and Computers and Technology news, refreshed every half hour

Q-Link mail and On-Line Messages are reached through the Post Office choices in the menus (chapter 8). Other departments of the original service may say they are not available: their content went with Quantum.

3. People Connection

People Connection is where Q-Link comes alive. You enter the **Lobby**, a room for up to 23 people; if it is full, you go to Lobby A, B and so on.

Talking

Type a line and press **RETURN**: everyone in the room sees it next to your name. Lines that start with two slashes are commands:

Type	What it does
`//msg NAME text`	sends a private message (OLM) to NAME, wherever they are on Q-Link
`//who`	lists the people in your room
`//me waves hello`	shows "*YOURNAME waves hello"
`//roll`	rolls two six-sided dice for the room; `//roll 3 20` rolls three twenty-sided dice (up to 8 dice)
`//8ball`	asks the Magic 8-Ball a yes-or-no question
`//nick NAME`	switches to another screen name of your own account (not while playing a game)

Rooms, people and messages

From the People Connection menu you can list the public rooms and their head counts, go to a public room or create a new one by giving it a name, or meet friends in a **private room** whose name only you and they know. You can also:

- **Locate** a member: Q-Link tells you which room they are in (or which casino table!).
- **Identify** a member: their city, state and country.
- Send an **On-Line Message** (OLM), a private note that pops up on their screen.

Good manners

Be friendly, keep it clean and remember there is a person on the other end. Members who make the place unpleasant for others can be removed by staff. Staff members show as "QuantumLink RELOADED Staff Member" when you Identify them.

4. Head-to-Head Games

Q-Link's games are played live between members in the same room. Each player needs the disk the game is on.

Game	Disk
Four in a Row, Chess, Backgammon, Bridge (4 players)	Q-Link game disk 1
Checkers, Reversi	Q-Link game disk 2

Playing

1. Meet your opponent in a room.
2. From the People Connection menu, choose to play a game, pick the game and invite the other player.
3. When everyone has accepted, Q-Link asks each player for the game disk and loads the game.
4. To leave, use the game's own menu. When you are back, Q-Link asks for your Q-Link disk.

> **TIP** Four in a Row and Chess have been played many times on Q-Link Reloaded. The other games use the same system and are expected to work; tell the system operator if one does not.

5. RabbitJack's Casino



Step through the saloon doors of **RabbitJack's Casino**: blackjack tables, slot machines, a bingo parlor and a poker room, a piano player in the corner, and the high rollers' **Hall of Fame** on the wall. Everything is played with **Q-Chips**, play money that costs nothing and buys nothing. Just bragging rights.

Your Q-Chips

Rule	
Your first visit	you receive **1,000** Q-Chips
Every day	on your first visit of the day, if you have fewer than 500, you are topped up to **500** (days run on New York time)
The limit	the casino screens count to **9,999**, so that is the most you can hold. A win that would take you over is cut to fit, and the casino tells you so
One bankroll per member	all your screen names share one bankroll

Entering the casino

1. Go to People Connection and choose to play **RabbitJack's Casino** from the games list.
2. When asked, put the **casino disk** in the drive.
3. You arrive in **RabbitJack's Lounge**. After a moment the welcome text clears and the lounge is ready.

In the lounge, **F3** and **F4** take you to the games (the lounge's own **Instructions** explain the moves), and **F7** opens the menu for where you stand: the lounge menu, or the menu of the game you are at. In every menu, the cursor keys move and **F1** chooses; **F5** goes back.

The lounge menu

Choice	What it does
Check My Bankroll Balance	how many Q-Chips you have

Choice	What it does
Check My High Scores	your best session in each game
RabbitJack's Hall Of Fame	All-Time Casino Leaders (biggest bankrolls), This Week's Leaders, and the best session at bingo, blackjack, poker and slots for all time, this week or today
Transfer Chips	give Q-Chips to another member (rules below)
Instructions	how to move around the casino
More ...	Locate Someone, Show Names Of People In This Lounge, Show Room Name, Ask The Piano Player To Play A Tune (Easy Winners or Weeping Willow), the Q-Link Post Office (OLMs and mail), and Leave RabbitJack's Casino (back to People Connection, or Sign Off)

Transfer Chips lets you share your luck. Both you and the receiver must have been casino members for **7 days** and played **5 sittings**; you can send up to **500** at a time and **1,000** a day; you cannot send to your own other screen names, and nobody can be pushed over the limit by gifts.

Choosing a table

Every game menu offers the same choices:

- **Assign Me To A Table** (or machine, or parlor): the casino seats you, at a table where others are already playing if there is room.
- **Go To A Specific One**: type its number.
- **List Existing Ones**: shows the open tables with their stakes and players, ten to a page (RETURN for more, F5 to stop).

Game	Numbers	Stakes
Blackjack	tables 1-99 / 100-199 / 200-299	bets 5-100 / 25-500 / 100-2,000
Slot machines	machines 1-99 / 100-199 / 200-299	1 / 5 / 25 Q-Chips a coin
Bingo	parlors 1-99	10 Q-Chips a card
Poker	tables 1-99 / 100-199	ante 5, bets 10 / ante 25, bets 50

"Show Number" in a game's menu tells you where you are.

Blackjack

Up to five players play against the dealer.

1. **NEW HAND!** Press **F3** to raise your wager and **F4** to lower it, in steps of the table minimum. The bar counts down; your wager is placed when it ends. Wager nothing to sit a hand out.
2. You and the dealer get two cards each; one of the dealer's is face down.

3. **Your turn**: the screen shows your card total. **F3** hits (another card), **F4** stands. On your first two cards you may **Double Down** from the menu: your wager doubles and you get exactly one more card.
4. The dealer turns over the hidden card and draws to 17 or more, then the results are shown and paid.

Result	You get back
Win (higher than the dealer, or the dealer busts)	twice your wager
Tie	your wager
Blackjack (21 on your first two cards)	**three times your wager**, paid at once
Bust (over 21)	nothing, even if the dealer busts too

The house uses six decks, and the dealer stands on every 17. There is no splitting or insurance. Aces count 1 or 11, picture cards 10, and you can hold at most five cards. If you are slow, the table moves on after about 20 seconds and you stand.

Slot machines

1. **F3** puts in a coin; up to three.
2. **F4** spins.
3. The reels stop one by one and any win is paid into your chips.

How many coins? One coin plays the **middle** row, two coins the **top and middle** rows, three coins **all three** rows. You win only on rows you paid for.

Line	Pays (coins)	Line	Pays
Seven Seven Seven	**the JACKPOT**	Diamond Diamond Diamond	300
BAR BAR BAR	150	Bell Bell Bell (or Bell Bell BAR)	18
Lemon Lemon Lemon (or Lemon Lemon BAR)	14	Orange Orange Orange (or Orange Orange BAR)	10
Cherry Cherry Cherry	10	Cherry Cherry	5
Cherry	3		

The **jackpot** is shared by every machine in the casino and grows with every coin played. When someone hits it, every player sees the winner's name, and the jackpot starts again at 500.

Bingo

1. Inside a parlor, the box shows the parlor number, the time until the next game and the card price.

2. Choose **New Card!** until you like your card, then **Register This Card For Next Game**. The price is taken from your chips.
3. The game starts: the screen shows how many players and how many Q-Chips are in the pot. A ball is called every few seconds.
4. **F3** marks the called number on your card.
5. When you have a line (any row, column or diagonal; the centre is free), press **F4** for **BINGO!** Q-Link checks your card against the numbers called, so a forgotten mark does not hurt you.

The **pot** is 90% of the cards sold and at least 100 Q-Chips. Two winners on the same ball share it. A new game starts every three minutes while anyone is in the parlor. Leave before a game starts and you get your card price back.

Stud Poker

Five-card stud for up to five players, one card face down. Real players, no house hand.

1. **NEW HAND!** Press **F3** to ante (the table minimum).
2. Everyone gets a face-down **hole card** and one face-up card. Choose **Peek** to look at your hole card.
3. **Your turn**: the menu offers **Check** (pass), **Bet** or **Fold**, or, if someone has bet, **Call**, **Raise** or **Fold**.
4. Three more face-up cards follow, each with a round of betting. Then the best hand takes the pot.

To	Press
Check or Call	cursor **down**, **F1**
Bet or Raise	cursor **down**, **down**, **F1**, then **F3**, then **F1** to confirm
Fold	cursor **down** three times, **F1**, then **F1** to confirm

Bets are a fixed size (10 at tables 1-99, 50 at tables 100-199), with at most three raises in a round. You have 30 seconds to act: then you check, or fold if there is a bet to call. Ranks, low to high: high card, one pair, two pairs, three of a kind, straight, flush, full house, four of a kind, straight flush. The house takes a small rake from the larger pots: 5 Q-Chips from pots of 100 or more at the 5/10 tables.

Leaving

From any game menu choose to leave the table: you return to the lounge (put the casino disk back in if asked). From the lounge's **More ...** menu choose **Leave RabbitJack's Casino** to go back to People Connection (with your Q-Link disk) or to sign off.

6. Super-Q and the Music Connection

Super-Q is a souped-up People Connection: a faster chat screen with its own menus, colours you choose, and the **Music Connection**, a library of more than 16,000 Commodore tunes played by your own SID chip.

Starting Super-Q

1. Sign on with your Q-Link disk as usual.
2. **Before** you choose People Connection, put the **Super-Q disk** in the drive.
3. Choose People Connection: Super-Q loads instead of the ordinary chat screen.

Change Super-Q's colours with the `COLORS` program on the Super-Q disk (`LOAD"COLORS",8` and `RUN`); your choice is saved in its `PREFERENCES` file.

The Super-Q menu

Choice	What it does
Room Menu	list the public rooms, go to a public or private room, Box Office, Auditorium
OLM Menu	send an OLM, send e-mail, read waiting mail, disk commands
Music Connection	browse the music library by artist, by letter or by title
Locate	where a member is
Identify	a member's city, state and country
Highlight / Remove highlighting	make one member's lines stand out
Ignore / Stop ignoring	hide one member's lines from your screen
Play a SID File	type a tune's title and hear it

Cursor keys move, **F1** chooses, **F3** or **F5** leaves a menu. In Super-Q you can also type `//join ROOM` and `//pjoin ROOM` to go straight to a public or private room.

The Music Connection

- **Browse**: Music Connection > choose an artist or a letter, then a title. Menus show up to ten choices.
- **Play by name**: Play a SID File > type the title, for example `CASEY JR`, and press **RETURN**. Use spaces between words; the underscore key does not type. If several tunes match, Q-Link tells you how many: press **F5** and pick one from the menu.

- **Play for the room**: everyone in your room hears the tune together. Q-Link loads it into each member's computer and starts it at the same moment.

Leaving Super-Q

Super-Q has no "return to the main menu" choice yet; one is on the way. For now, sign off when you are done, and start Q-Link again for the other departments.

7. Club Caribe

Q-LINK RELOADED

Welcome to **Club Caribe**, the tropical island resort built by Lucasfilm Games (it began life as **Habitat** in 1986). Here you are not a line of text but an **avatar**: a little animated person who walks, talks in word balloons, waves, picks things up, and meets other members' avatars from all over the world.

What you need

Item	Notes
Club Caribe disk, side 1	the program disk. Use the corrected disk from the system operator: the original kit writes this disk with a fault that makes Q-Link stop after you insert it
Club Caribe disk, side 2	the **imagery** disk with all the pictures, sounds and objects of the world
A joystick	in **port 1**

> **IMPORTANT** Club Caribe **writes to the imagery disk** when you enter, to keep it up to date. Use your own copy, write-enabled, one per member, and never your only original.

Entering Club Caribe

1. Sign on, go to People Connection and choose **Club Caribe** from the games list.
2. When asked, put in **side 1**. Club Caribe loads.
3. When asked for the **imagery disk**, put in **side 2** and press a key.
4. You materialise at the **Plaza Fountain** in downtown Populopolis. Your avatar carries your screen name, and you start with money in the bank.

Moving and acting

Move the **pointer** with the joystick. Hold the **fire button** and push the stick to give a command about what the pointer is on:

Fire button +	Command	Example
Up	**GO**	point at a spot on the ground: your avatar walks there. Point at the edge of the scene to walk to the next one
Down	**DO**	use something: open a door, sit on a chair
Right	**GET**	pick up the thing under the pointer
Left	**PUT**	put down what you hold

Talk by simply typing a line and pressing **RETURN**: it appears in a word balloon over your avatar for everyone in the scene.

F1 turns you into a **ghost**, an invisible floating eye that can watch a scene and travel between scenes, but cannot walk around inside one, talk or touch things. Point at the scene and press **F1** again to become your avatar once more.

> **TIP** On the VICE emulator, set Joystick port 1 to the numeric keypad: the keypad moves the pointer and **Right Ctrl** is the fire button. So Right Ctrl + keypad 8 is GO.

8. Mail and News

Q-Link Post Office

Send **mail** to any member, signed on or not; they find it waiting the next time they visit the Post Office. An **OLM** (On-Line Message) is different: it pops up at once on the screen of a member who is signed on now. Both can also be sent from inside the casino (More ... > Q-Link Post Office).

News & Information

Live News Headlines and **Computers and Technology** bring today's headlines to your Commodore, refreshed every half hour. Choose a section, then a headline.

9. Signing Off

Choose **Sign Off** from the main menu, or **Sign Off** in the casino's Leave menu. Q-Link shows your time on, time off and total time, and returns you to BASIC. Then hang up your modem as its manual describes.

10. Help!

Trouble	Try this
Q-Link stops right after signing on (emulator)	your disk image is on a network drive or write-protected; copy it to your own computer
The screen freezes now and then, especially in the casino	you dialled with `ATDT`; dial with `ATD` (or turn IP232 off in VICE)
"Already logged in" after your line dropped	wait a minute and try again; if it persists, ask the system operator
The casino stays on "the menu of options will be available in a few moments"	sign off and try again; tell the system operator if it repeats
"Go To Another Table" hangs	your casino disk needs the corrected version; leave to the lounge and choose a new table there instead
Club Caribe stops after you insert side 1	you need the corrected side 1 disk
The avatar will not move (emulator)	set a joystick on port 1
Super-Q: no way back to the main menu	sign off (a return choice is coming)
Your access code is refused	ask the system operator for a new one and enter it with `CHANGE ACCESS`

Quick Reference Card

Everywhere	
Cursor keys	move the highlight
F1	choose
F5	back / cancel
F7	menu (casino, games)

Casino	
Lounge	F3 / F4 to the games, F7 menu
Blackjack	F3 / F4 wager; F3 hit, F4 stand; Double Down in the menu
Slots	F3 coin (up to 3), F4 spin
Bingo	menu: New Card, Register; F3 mark, F4 BINGO
Poker	F3 ante; down + F1 check/call; down, down, F1, F3, F1 bet/raise; down x3, F1, F1 fold

Chat	
`//msg NAME text`	private message
`//who` · `//me` · `//roll` · `//8ball`	room fun
`//nick NAME`	switch screen names

Club Caribe	
Fire + up / down / right / left	GO / DO / GET / PUT
Type + RETURN	talk
F1	ghost on / off

Q-Link Reloaded Member's Guide, Edition 1. Written for the Q-Link Reloaded server rev9 and its Club Caribe service. Not affiliated with Quantum Computer Services, America Online, Lucasfilm or their successors.